

Tianyi Zhang

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EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

Master of Science in Computer Science

Atlanta, GA

Aug 2025 – May 2027

Emory University

Bachelor of Science in Quantitative Sciences

Atlanta, GA

Aug 2021 – May 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

LinkedIn Corporation

Machine Learning Engineer Intern

Mountain View, CA

May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Improved a production **two-tower retriever** by correcting dwell-heavy supervision, missing rejection signals, and imputed-negative evaluation.
- Designed and handed off a serving-aware **VLM-teacher / embedding-student retriever**, distilling offline multimodal relevance and hard-negative supervision into precomputed ANN vectors for downstream ranking.
- Shipped **billion-scale offline evaluation** across matched lifecycle/signal cohorts; removed cohort and candidate-pool confounds and exposed a relevance–breadth tradeoff using coverage, complementarity, and topical diversity.

Georgia Tech EIC Lab · NVIDIA AI Research

Student Researcher

Atlanta, GA

Jul 2025 – Dec 2025

- Engineered the **AgentSuite** benchmark-auditing pipeline with a taxonomy-guided LLM judge and deterministic structural detectors, matching expert audits at **0.79–0.87 F1** across **6 benchmarks**.
- Generalized to unseen benchmarks without retuning; identified flaws in **23% of tasks** whose correction changed **63% of model rankings**.

Emory Graph Mining Lab

Machine Learning Researcher

Atlanta, GA

Dec 2023 – May 2025

- Designed a **Granger-causal DAG framework** that converts fMRI time series into directed brain networks, exposing asymmetric dependencies hidden by correlation graphs and improving diagnostic prediction.
- Co-developed a **Brain Network State Transformer** that clusters dynamic connectivity into recurring latent states and models intra-/inter-state structure for downstream prediction.

PUBLICATIONS

H. Suh*, S. Lee*, B. Ji*, R. Khare, B. Khan, H. Kim, **T. Zhang**, et al. “AgentSuite: Toward More Reliable Agent Evaluation with a Component-Based Benchmark Auditing Pipeline” *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)* 2026.

T. Zhang, K. Han, J. Nie, et al. “Causal Brain Connectivity: Integrating Granger Directed Graphs in fMRI Analysis.” *International Conference on Artificial Intelligence in Medicine (AIME)* 2025.

J. Nie, K. Han, **T. Zhang**, et al. “Brain Network State Transformer: Leveraging State Functional Connectivity.” *IEEE Engineering in Medicine and Biology Society (EMBC)* 2025. (Oral)

OPEN SOURCE

NVIDIA NeMo RL (2.0K stars)

Merged PRs  Open PRs 

Open-Source Contributor | Scalable toolkit for efficient LLM reinforcement learning and post-training.

- Performance & Correctness (merged)**: Optimized log-probability and top-*k* distillation paths, making cross-token P-KL **3.7× faster** and reducing tensor-parallel communication from **250 MiB to 16 MiB per rank**.
- Multi-Reward GDPO (under review)**: Preserved named reward components end to end across async rollout, replay, checkpoint/restore, and custom policy objectives, enabling composable multi-reward post-training.
- SingleController PPO (under review)**: Streamed actor and critic minibatches instead of materializing merged payloads, reducing memory pressure while preserving functional resume and training parity on H100s.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages

Python, Go, SQL, C/C++, Java, R

ML Frameworks

PyTorch, TensorFlow, PyTorch Lightning, Hugging Face Transformers

Post-Training

NVIDIA NeMo RL, verl, vLLM, SGLang, CUDA

Data & Tools

PySpark, Apache Spark, Flyte, MLflow, FastAPI, Docker, AWS, GitHub Actions, Linux